



REAL
Saturday

REAL TIMES

Real News in Real Time

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Tik tok ticked off

....HH commissions refurbished radiotherapy cancer equipment, deploras culture of hospital staff spending hours on their phones

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HH increases UNZA students' allowance

By Ruth Kambita

President Hakainde Hichilema has increased the student accommodation allowance at the University of Zambia from K3, 900 to K5,850, effective immediately.

Speaking at State House in Lusaka today, Mr Hichilema said the decision followed sustained engagement with student leaders and broader efforts to fix long-standing water, sanitation and hostel infrastructure problems at UNZA, which opened in the late 1960s.

"Having listened to my fellow monks and mamas and to their student leaders, I, Hakainde Hichilema 'Buddy' have made the decision that the accommodation allowance will be increased... from K3,900 to K5,850," the President said.

The announcement comes after months of student protests over blocked sewers, poor sanitation and inadequate hostels. The government deployed the Zambia National Service, working with the Army, Air Force and Correctional Service, to carry out urgent repairs hosted by hostel.

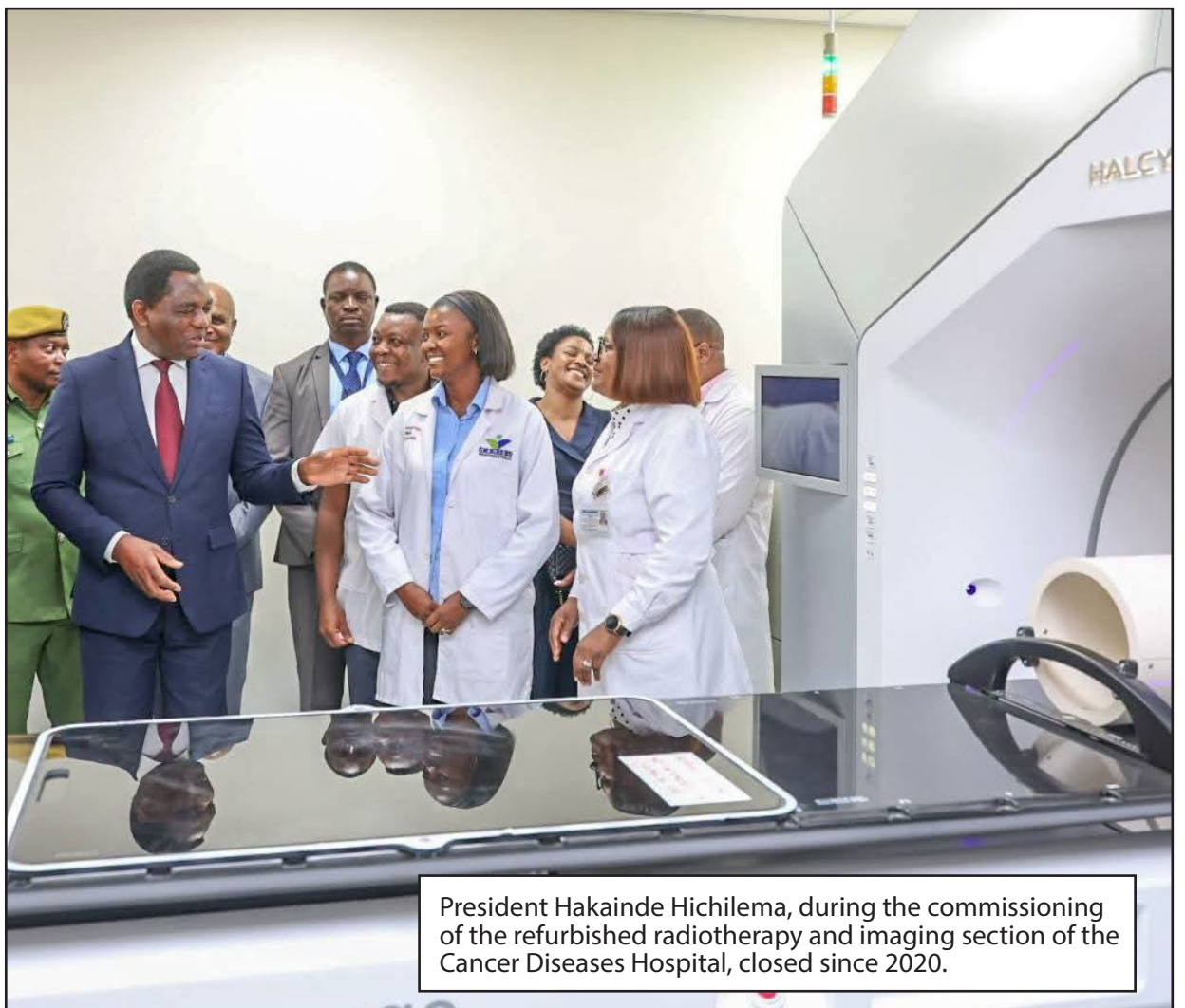
We worked on this sanitation

not to be thanked... but we did it as our duty, as our obligation to show our love and care for my friends the young people of Zambia," Mr Hichilema said, urging students to protect the rehabilitated facilities and avoid dumping solid waste into the sewer system.

University of Zambia Students Union (UNZASU) President Mwanto Kabaso thanked the President, saying students had marched eight months ago demanding a permanent solution. UNZASU vice-president Jemimah Mwaba said the improvements had already changed daily life, especially for female students.

While celebrating the gains, Mr Hichilema urged students to back his party in the upcoming polls, appointing them as campaign managers and telling them: "Whenever you have problems, don't go in the streets.

Zambia National Service (ZNS) Commander Lieutenant-General Maliti Solochi said, following Presidential instructions, teams had inspected and worked on hostels across campus, adding: "Since 1966... I think this is the first time that work has been done."



President Hakainde Hichilema, during the commissioning of the refurbished radiotherapy and imaging section of the Cancer Diseases Hospital, closed since 2020.

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Real News in Real Time

Kayz Adam is “drowning”



By Alex Maboshe

Rising Zambian star, Kayz Adams has dropped a new single titled “Drowning,” continuing his streak of emo-

tionally charged tracks that blend heartfelt storytelling with infectious rhythms. The song, released earlier this week, showcases the artist’s signature mix of Chewa and English lyrics over a smooth, atmospheric production that shifts between reflective verses and a soaring, melodic chorus. Early listeners are describing it as a vulnerable exploration of feeling over-

whelmed pressure, or life’s challenges while still fighting to stay afloat. Kayz Adams has steadily built a strong following with previous releases including the popular “Aliko,” the romantic ballad “ADAM” (featuring Triple M), “TULO” with Jae Cash, “Ghetto Child,” and collaborations that have helped him stand out in Zambia’s vibrant music scene. “Drowning” feels like a natural next step, leaning into the introspective side that has earned him praise for socially conscious and personal material.

Fans have already begun circulating the track on social media and streaming platforms, with many highlighting the singer’s distinctive vocal delivery and the song’s relatable theme. One early reaction called it “another win for Kayz deep lyrics, clean production, and that voice that hits different.” The very short but impactful record dropped alongside its official music video that showcased emotional expression blending with the message in the audio. Kayz Adams continues to solidify his place as one of the fresh voices in contemporary Zambian music. With “Drowning,” he once again proves he can turn raw emotion into something listeners want on repeat.

Fans mourn with - Sean



By Alex Maboshe

Fans and supporters of legendary Zambian multi-talented artist Richard Sean Mulenga, widely known as T-Sean Mr. Baila, have expressed deep sorrow, describing the musician as a fighter and a soldier. The death of his beloved wife, Sharai Mulenga, has revealed a side of the artist rarely seen by the public, one of profound vulnerability and heartbreak. Supporters have outlined a series of hardships T-Sean has endured in recent years, noting that while the path has been exceptionally difficult, he continues to rise. One Facebook user, Owen Kay’s Pesa, wrote “Behind the music, T-Sean is a man who has fought battles far beyond the stage. T-Sean has faced losses that could break anyone from

watching his home and expensive studio, built through years of sacrifice and hard work, go up in flames in 2021, to losing his powerful Facebook platform with over 1.7 million followers in 2024, a page that played a major role in his business and brand. The storms continued when his YouTube channel was hacked, taking away another important piece of his musical journey. And now, in 2026, he faces his most painful loss yet the passing of his beloved wife. Behind the hits, the awards, and the performances is a man who has carried unimaginable pain but continues to stand strong. A story of loss, resilience, sacrifice, and the strength to keep going.” However, some wonder if he will manage to pick himself up again noting that his current pain is a different type of pain.

Agric institutions develop drought resistant crops

By Linda Nyondo

Ministry of Agriculture Permanent Secretary for Technical Services, John Mulongoti says agriculture research institutions have come up with

solutions to tackle challenges created by drought. Mr Mulongoti said the research centre’s are responding well to unstable climatic challenges by coming up with innovations that respond to

climatic challenges. “We are happy because these research institutes have come up with drought solutions to answer to the challenges farmers encounter as a result of drought” the Permanent Secretary says. He also said that a number of investments have been made across the country with the aim of equipping farmers with alternative farming methods in an event of climatic change. The farmers are also being supplied with hybrid seed that suits climatic changes. To respond to the challenges the country is faced with in the Agriculture sector, policies have been revised and are being implemented as a way of improving the environment in the sector. To improve the Agriculture sector, the Government has distributed farming kits, Seed, fertilizer, chemicals and other farming kits. Government has also come up with the mulimi services under the Agriculture extension services. With the Mulimi 360, farmers can access services online in places of their convenience. Many other innovations are being worked on to improve the Agriculture sector. The past drought the Country had experienced is said to have been a work up call.

Tik tok ticked off

By Sam Phiri

Medical staff may be returning to work after the long weekend to new guidelines about the use of mobile devices while on duty after President Hachilema expressed his displeasure at staff spending too much time looking at their phones during working hours. President Hachilema said if it was possible, he would have mobile signals “obliterated” at hospitals to ensure that staff was paying more attention to screening patients than staring at the blue screens in their hands. Speaking during the commissioning of the ultra-modern radio cancer treatment equipment at the Cancer Diseases Hospital (CDH) today admonished staff for unprofessional behaviour and called for improved work habits and efficiency. The President however said minimal use of mobile phones for medical inquiries and not tik tok would be permissible. Mr Hachilema said Zambia is rapidly expanding its national cancer-treatment capacity and aiming to become a regional hub for oncology services. He said government planned to more than double treatment capacity within a year. He singled out Livingstone as a priority and urged Professor Chilengi to expedite construction, stressing the site is a health facility, not a hotel. “Three rules: pricing must be right, quality must be right, deliver on time,” he said. The president said Zambia, alongside South Africa and Egypt, could form a regional

triangle of cancer treatment, and outlined plans for a “medical city” near the airport that would offer integrated services including a heart-treatment centre. He described the concept as part of a broader health-tourism agenda and said the project was at the planning stage. Mr Hachilema praised the modern equipment already in place, saying some devices were more advanced than those in neighbouring countries. He warned, however, that technology must be matched by skilled personnel and pledged continued government support for training, exchanges and retraining for medical staff. “The Minister of Health is one of the largest beneficiaries of every national budget in this country,” he said. Highlighting digital progress, the president welcomed near real-time diagnostic and treatment linkages but ordered remaining gaps to be closed to fully automate the facility. He urged that regional marketing be prioritised so patients who would otherwise travel abroad are treated in Zambia. Mr Hachilema also said the Treasury had cleared legacy bills for patients sent overseas and instructed officials to halt approvals for foreign referrals where local capacity exists. Concluding, the president urged Zambians to protect the progress in healthcare, saying the government’s investments were about “saving lives, restoring hope and delivering dignity.”

Armed illegal immigrant shot dead

By Ruth Kambita

An armed suspected prohibited immigrant has been shot dead at the Kafue Security Checkpoint after allegedly opening fire on law enforcement officers during a routine immigration operation. The incident, which occurred today at about 08:30 hours, left no officers or members of the public injured, according to a joint statement by Police spokesperson Godfrey Chilabi and Department of Immigration Chief Public Relations Officer Namati Nshinka. The suspect was intercepted by officers who began verifying a National Registration Card suspected to be fraudulent. Upon discovery that he was armed, the suspect fled and opened fire on an immigration officer who was pursuing him. A police officer confronted the suspect about 200 metres from the checkpoint and fatally wounded him after the suspect continued firing, posing a threat to both law enforcement and members of the public. A firearm loaded with 13 rounds of ammunition was recovered from the deceased. Preliminary investigations indicate that four rounds were fired, while nine live rounds were recovered from the scene and secured as exhibits. The body has been taken to Kafue General Hospital Mortu-

ary pending a post-mortem examination. Authorities believe the deceased is the same individual who escaped from lawful custody after being apprehended by immigration officers on March 19 this year. The Zambia Police Service has launched investigations into the shooting, while the Department of Immigration is conducting separate investigations into the immigration aspects of the case. The suspect’s identity and nationality remain under investigation, and forensic examinations on the recovered National Registration Card are underway.

‘No turning back’ - ConCourt

By Alex Maboshe

The Constitutional Court has ruled that a running mate who has been validly nominated cannot resign or withdraw from an election. In a judgment delivered today, the court held that the Constitution requires a running mate to remain on the ballot from the filing of nomination papers until polling day, except in the event of death. The decision arose from a petition by governance activist Isaac Mwanza, who sought an interpretation of constitutional provisions on the withdrawal, resignation or stepping down of a presidential candidate or running mate, and the consequences of such actions for the electoral process. The case followed the post-nomination withdrawal of two duly nominated vice-presidential running mates, Moses Mawere and Andyford Banda. Both announced they were leaving their respective presi-

dential tickets and supporting other candidates. The court found that Articles 110, 45 and 52 of the Constitution do not allow a running mate to become the presidential candidate in these circumstances. A fresh nomination process must instead be conducted in accordance with the law. It further clarified that if a presidential candidate or running mate withdraws before ballot papers are printed, the Electoral Commission of Zambia must remove that person’s

name from the ballot, as they would no longer be eligible to contest the election. However, where the resignation or withdrawal occurs after ballot papers have already been printed, it may not be practical to remove the name. In such cases the name may remain on the ballot for practical reasons, but any votes cast for that candidate will not count as valid votes in determining the outcome of the presidential election.

Saturday Specials



UNZA students' visit to State House in Lusaka today



Geo-economics



By Darlington Chiluba

Pressure, fatigue days before decision day



By Dr Orleans Mfune

It's the first day of August and the campaign trail enters the most decisive week. There are untouched places, undecided voters and indeed, a few killer messages to deliver! And all this adds pressure on campaign teams. Sometimes campaigns seem like a game, thrilling and dramatic. But in reality this is the game that will decide the fate of the nation for the next foreseeable future. Because of the critical importance of this period, let's look at what is at stake for the candidates and the nation at large. It's been weeks of campaigning and for each one of the candidates, the prize is only one; a seat at the council, parliament or indeed at plot one. The results of the election will either make or break

some individuals. For some, it may not only be about losing elections, but also resources invested in campaigns. The reality is that it is quite expensive to run a campaign and some people run the race on the basis of debt. And some, I have heard, invest their entire pension or capital in this process. Some still, have abandoned their promising careers for a chance at Manda Hill! So the stakes are high. For the nation, general elections are about the very soul of the nation. We miss it and our country is broken. We get it right and our future is secure. We also have a chance to fix our councils and parliament. Given what is at stake and the tempo of the campaign, the pressure and strain is now beginning to show. The elections are particularly straining for Presidential candidates who have to criss-cross all corners of the country. The fact that Zambia is a huge country with over 750,000 square kilometres does not make it easy. Thus, it is not surprising to hear some mixed messages or even strange utterances from our candidates during this time. Its largely the impact of mounting pressure and fatigue as the election day draws near. But as pressure mounts and the day approaches, it is also a critical time for candidates

to maintain composure and stay focused on the game. This week is a decisive week. People are going through the campaign messages and weighing the candidates. Each promise made, each issue raised, is being discussed in bars, coffee shops, living rooms and social media. Thus for me, this window is important time for tightening or refining messages and taking a clear stand on some issues. Campaign managers must take note of people's discussions and issues raised in various platforms such as social media to help their candidates consolidate clear and compelling messages as we take this last lap. They must also do what it takes to repair damaged images or indeed refine the images of their candidates. This may help win some undecided voters or indeed win some voters back. Besides this, they must also help their candidates manage the fatigue that may take a toll on the physical and mental health of the candidates. For the rest of us, our responsibility is clear. It is simply to decide on who is the best man or woman for the job. It is that time when we put our tribal, social or regional differences away to make a decision for the future of our nation. We have one country, one nation and that is Zambia!

The campaign for Zambia's independence was about legally securing the country's resources for the ultimate benefit of its natives. Even in the 1950s, the proposed thinking was that pockets of land that had value such as copper and great agro and aqua potential should have been reserved in a trust for future citizens of what became Zambia. The plan was to make sure that the future did not find natives of Zambia begging for respect in their own nation while capital remained outside their reach. In simple logic, there should be a direct correlation between the resource endowment of a country and the living standards of its citizens. This is partly the reason social justice is an intrinsic principle of executive power so that equitable distribution of resources is driven from the highest authority. This may also explain the interlink of capital and political power, in other words, it defines geo-economy. In Zambia for example, the years between 1963 and 1971 were spent investing in human capital through free education and other services that elevated the citizens to understanding national management. The First Republic inherited a well functioning but small economy and this is a common story with former colonies. From these inherited fortunes earned from locally endowed resources, the government provided free education and many amenities.

The centralised economy adopted during the Second Republic went on to use the geoeconomy to support regional independence movements in the 1970s. Zambia was one of the countries that sponsored liberation movements in the region and on the continent of Africa as a whole. It is not surprising therefore to see that the economic power of the country began declining when its regional political influence started to grow. Nations with greater geoeconomic power exerted force by restricting trade routes for imports and exports among others. The result was a failing economy without reserves and forced to survive on debt while leveraging its natural resources. A greater part of the problem was that politics, and the survival of the ruling class was prioritised over national interests of the greater population. The coming of the Third Republic was a systemic shift of geoeconomy so that the full scope of natural resources benefited everyone, not a select few. Economic influence was elevated through deregulation – creation of free enterprise and unlocking human capital contribution. It is during this time that the revenue authority was established in its current form. The decentralisation of the central bank and liberalisation across multiple economic sectors enabled government to broaden its resource envelope. The outcome was that a foundation to build and grow reserves for the future was established. In terms of

geo economic, the impact of the First, Second and Third Republics on human capital is evident. The direct application of geoeconomics to influence regional and international standing was most prominent between the 1970s and about 2001. Consecutive administrations have left a blueprint on the national agenda and each drawn administration from constituents and strongholds. At executive level, to measure performance of a given administration by isolating impact on human capital - such as improvements in livelihood, equitable access to justice and other resources, freedom of enterprise or freedom of speech - will always draw subjective conclusions. To draw a direct line between the aspirations for independence in 1951 and modern Zambia, the main issue would be the direct economic and social security the citizens gain during each administration. When it comes to the link between natives (or citizens) and resources endowed within national borders, the question is who should benefit, if not citizens?

In terms of geoeconomy, it is simply that how has government used its tools to ensure that there is tangible equitable distribution of national resources? Elections are judged on these terms, not statistics. When there is a disconnect or distance between what numbers communicate and the living standards of the masses then the outcome will determine who better used the geoeconomic advantage at their disposal. For example, the rate of inflation is unable to communicate the reality that people are unable to afford basic commodities, the obvious conclusion would be that the economic independence of citizens is not a concern, but rather what they are able to put on the plate and the comfort they enjoy not what the statisticians adduce.

All eyes now on WAFCON, Mpali



TV Analysis

By Sam Phiri

All eyes are on the 2026 Women's Africa Cup of Nations, where the continent's finest contend not only for

a trophy but for the accelerating recognition of women's football. Zambia announced themselves loudly in the opening rounds, routing Egypt 6-0 in a statement of intent that set social feeds and punditry alight. Their reward was a high-stakes clash with reigning champions Nigeria, a side reeling from an improbable defeat by tournament debutants Malawi. Nigeria arrive wounded in spirit rather than squad. Their coach has described the meeting with Zambia as a decisive lifeline; a win would restore momentum and calm frayed nerves. Zambia's coach, by contrast, is buoyant despite a past reverse to the same opponents. That mixture of confidence and caution frames the duel: one team desperately defending legacy, the other chasing a landmark evolution. On form alone, Zambia have answered longstanding questions about attacking firepower but still face concerns over consistency against technically disciplined sides such as Morocco and a surprisingly robust Malawi. Their 6-0 triumph showcased finishing and width, yet defensive organisation and midfield control will be tested against opponents who

prize possession and pressing. Nigeria's tactical nous and tournament experience remain potent weapons, but vulnerability in transition was exposed against Malawi — a chink that Zambia will seek to exploit. If Zambia can marry attacking verve with greater defensive discipline, they can trouble any of the favourites. Conversely, Nigeria's ability to recalibrate quickly will determine whether they reassert dominance or slip from a position of continental hegemony. Either outcome would mark a significant chapter in African women's football: deepening competition, shifting hierarchies and growing global attention. Away from the pitch, Zambezi Magic's Mpali continues to enthrall. The series has pivoted from the Nguzu wives to the younger couples, with Shadreck's fraught household now centre stage dominating conversation. Alexander's mysterious disappearance has injected fresh suspense, ensuring Monday's episode is appointment viewing for many

ZPL to kick off on Sept. 12, 2026

By Benedict Tembo

The Zambian Premier League (ZPL) has announced that the 2026 Transition League will tentatively kick off on September 12, 2026, and run until December as the country prepares to usher in a new era with the adoption of a revised football calendar.

According to ZPL Head of Communications Christina Zulu, the transitional competition will provide a bridge between the current football structure and the new calendar set to take effect in 2027, with changes introduced across several domestic leagues.

The MTN Super League will be a temporary two-stream format during the Transition League, with clubs divided according to their final positions in the 2025-2026 league standings.

Teams that finish in odd-numbered positions will compete in one stream, while those occupying even-numbered positions will be placed in the other.

The ZPL has also confirmed that the Women's Super League, Men's National Division and Women's National Division, will operate on a regional basis during the transition period.

Clubs in these competitions will be grouped into North and South regions for the duration of the tournament.

Following the conclusion of the Transition League, the Men's National Division and the Women's Super League will revert to national competitions for the start of the full 2027 season.

The Women's National Division, however, will continue under a regional structure.

The new format was approved by the ZPL Board during its meeting on July 24, 2026, as preparations intensify for Zambia's football calendar transition.

The introduction of the Transition League is expected to help clubs, players, and administrators adjust to the new football calendar while maintaining competitive action before the commencement of the 2027 season.

The Transitional League will pave way for the return of the old soccer calendar which ran from March to December.

Kangwa hops from Israel to Greece in most expensive Zambian deal



By Benedict Tembo



Chipolopolo midfielder Kings Kangwa's recent transfer from Israel to Greek top side Panathinaikos has probably made him Zambia's most expensive player.

At nearly €4 million Kangwa joined Greek giants Panathinaikos from Israeli club Hapoel Be'er Sheva, Kangwa became the most valuable Zambian player.

Kangwa, who treks to Athens with an impressive record of having guided Hapoel Be'er Sheva to the 2025-2026 Israeli league title, has signed a four-year contract after successfully passing his medicals.

The central midfielder's transfer is valued at nearly €4 million and is probably one of the most lucrative deals involving a Zambian player in recent years.

The 27-year-old Kangwa arrived in Athens in the company of his Israeli FIFA agent, Nir Karin, who brokered the deal.

The duo watched Panathinaikos in their UEFA Conference League match on Thursday prior to putting pen to paper on Friday.

Kangwa has played in Russia, Serbia, Belgium and Israel before moving to Greece.

Karin expressed confidence the player will win more trophies at his new destination.

"I am very happy for Kings Kangwa, and I am confident he will win more trophies at his new destination," Karin said.